

Discovery Question Map

CHEAT SHEET | SKILL: DISCOVERY | DIFFICULTY: INTERMEDIATE | EST. 6 MIN

Reviewed professional resource - AmplifyHub Practical Resource Library

Overview

A map of open questions across five areas - situation, problem, impact, goal, and next step - for a scheduled discovery conversation, so you explore instead of interrogate.

Learning objectives

- Cover five discovery areas with open questions
- Move from facts to impact naturally
- Avoid yes/no and leading questions
- Follow the prospect rather than a checklist

The map

Area	Example question
Situation	"How is this handled today?"
Problem	"Where does that tend to break down?"
Impact	"When it breaks, what does it cost you in time or stress?"
Goal	"What would good look like six months from now?"
Next step	"What would make it worth exploring further?"

Use it well

- This is for a booked discovery call, not a cold-call interrogation.
- Ask one question, then actually listen and follow the answer.
- You do not need every question - depth beats coverage.

Professional standard

Professional discovery helps both sides understand the current situation, impact, priorities, and decision process. Questions should follow what the person says rather than forcing a predetermined qualification path.

Professional workflow

1. Read the full guide once, then highlight only the two or three prompts that match the situation you are practising today.
2. Keep the cheat sheet visible as a reminder, not as a script. Look away from it while speaking so your attention stays on the conversation.
3. Rehearse the decision points, especially where the other person can redirect, disagree, or end the interaction.
4. Mark the guidance you actually used and write one short note about what happened. Real observations are more useful than trying to memorise every line.
5. Retire prompts that feel unnatural or do not fit your market. A smaller personalised reference is more professional than a crowded universal one.

Quality-control review

Review point	Professional standard	Warning sign
Agenda	Purpose, available time, and desired outcome are confirmed together.	The seller starts interrogating without setting context.
Question quality	Questions are open, neutral, and connected to the previous answer.	Questions are leading, stacked, or designed to trap agreement.
Depth	Specific examples and consequences are explored with permission.	The conversation stays abstract or rushes to a solution.
Recap	Facts, assumptions, priorities, and next steps are summarised accurately.	The seller paraphrases the answer into a stronger claim than was made.

Evidence and improvement signals

- Review talk balance alongside question quality; a lower talk ratio is not automatically better.
- Count how many important facts were confirmed in the final recap rather than assumed.
- Note unanswered questions and agree whether they matter before scheduling another step.
- Evaluate whether the proposed next step follows logically from the stated priority.

Worked example

Situation: "How do you schedule drivers now?" -> "Spreadsheets." Problem: "Where does that get painful?" -> "Last-minute changes." Impact: "What does a bad week cost you?" -> "Overtime and missed pickups." That thread is worth more than firing all five questions in order.

Safe-practice note

Discovery is a conversation, not a checklist to power through. Do not use it to trap someone with leading questions. Only use it when a discovery call is actually scheduled and welcome.

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